

Herald



Herald — rherald Flavor Guide (Operator)

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-05-30
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Status	active
Status summary	Nano-detail operator reference for rherald (Release Herald) — a CLI-only flavor (DefaultPort=0) for the release path. Documents changelog-generate (§5 Conventional-Commits changelog), tag-mirror (§4 cross-mirror tag-parity gate), gate-retest (§11.4.40 pre-tag full-suite retest gate), and version. ANTI-BLUFF: derived from the built rherald binary (rherald --help, per-subcommand --help, version --json) + commons/branding.go. The gates read recorded state and exit non-zero on a breach; they never create/push tags or run the suites themselves (§12/§107 host-safety).
Issues	(none specific to this guide)
Continuation	Bump as the release path gains commands.

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§1. What rherald is

rherald is **Release Herald** — flavor key r, prefix RHR, **CLI-only** (DefaultPort=0, no serve mode). Per commons/branding.go its mission is "Tag mirroring + changelog + installable-asset evidence". It is invoked at release time to (1) generate a Conventional-Commits changelog, (2) gate that a release tag has full parity across every owned mirror, and (3) gate that a green full-

suite retest preceded the tag. Per §12/§107 host-safety, `tag-mirror` and `gate-retest` are read-only/observe-only — they never create or push a tag, and never run the real test suite.

Build it:

```
go build -o /tmp/rherald ./rherald/cmd/rherald
```

§2. The subcommand surface

Verbatim from `rherald --help`:

Subcommand	What it does
<code>changelog-generate</code>	Generate a Conventional-Commits changelog for a release version (§5)
<code>tag-mirror</code>	Assert a release tag has full parity across every owned mirror (§4)
<code>gate-retest</code>	Pre-tag full-suite retest GATE: classify the recorded retest outcome (§11.4.40)
<code>version</code>	Print Release Herald version + build info
<code>completion</code>	Generate shell autocompletion (Cobra built-in)

All three classifying commands accept `--emit` (drive the verdict as a real constitution event) and `--repo string` (default: discovered from CWD).

§3. version

```
$ rherald version --json
{"arch":"arm64","binary":"rherald","build_time":"unknown","commit":"unknown dev"}
```

§4. changelog-generate

`changelog-generate <version>` reads the commit graph (optionally bounded by `--since <previous-tag>`), groups each commit subject by its Conventional-Commits type (`feat / fix / docs / ...`), writes the grouped changelog to `<out-dir>/<version>.md`, then classifies §5 conformance through the HRD-022 binding. **§5 is Warn-tier** — a non-conforming changelog is a warning, not a hard exit. The only write is the changelog file, scoped to the operator-supplied repo.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--out-dir string</code>	Output dir for <code><version>.md</code> (default <code><repo>/docs/changelogs</code>)
<code>--since string</code>	Previous tag/ref bounding the range (default: full history)
<code>--repo string</code>	Repo dir (default: discovered from CWD)

```
rherald changelog-generate v0.4.0 --since v0.3.0
```

§5. tag-mirror

`tag-mirror <tag>` observes whether release tag `<tag>` is present locally AND on every configured mirror remote, builds the §4 tag-mirror-parity Subject from the observed tally, and **exits non-zero when the verdict is FAIL** — a tag present on the parent but missing on any owned mirror is a §4 violation. Mirrors are read from the repeatable `--remote` flag or (default) from the `upstreams/*.sh` declarations. It **never creates or pushes a tag** — it reads tag state only via `ls-remote`.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--remote strings</code>	Mirror remote to check (repeatable; default: <code>upstreams/*.sh</code>)
<code>--upstreams-dir string</code>	Dir holding <code>/*.sh</code> mirror declarations (default <code><repo>/upstreams</code>)
<code>--repo string</code>	Repo dir (default: discovered from CWD)

```
rherald tag-mirror v0.4.0 || echo "MIRROR PARITY MISSING"
```

§6. gate-retest

PRE-TAG GATE: classifies whether the composite full-suite retest PASSED before a release tag (the highest-severity release gate) through the HRD-022 §11.4.40 binding, and **exits non-zero when the verdict is FAIL** — a tag attempted without a green all-tier retest is BLOCKED. The retest outcome is supplied via the `--retest-result` seam (or read from `--results-file`) so the gate is hermetically testable and **never runs the real test suite itself**.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--retest-result string</code>	Recorded composite retest outcome: pass/fail/green/red/skipped (test/CI seam)
<code>--results-file string</code>	File whose first line is the retest outcome (alternative to <code>--retest-result</code>)
<code>--tiers int</code>	Number of §40.2 test tiers the retest covered (must be ≥ 8 to pass) (default 8)
<code>--repo string</code>	Repo dir (default: discovered from CWD)

NOTE: `gate-retest` is the alias shared with `bherald gate-retest`; on `rherald` it is **live**, whereas the `bherald`-side body is still open (HRD-045).

§7. References

- Source: `rherald/cmd/rherald/main.go+release_cmds.go`.
- Branding: `commons/branding.go` (flavor `r`, `DefaultPort=0`).
- Mirror declarations: `upstreams/{GitHub,GitLab,GitFlic,GitVerse}.sh`.
- Constitution bindings: HRD-022 §4 / §5 / §11.4.40; §40.2 8-tier matrix.
- Companion flavor guides: `docs/guides/{PHERALD,SHERALD,CHERALD,BHERALD,IHERALD,SCHERALD,QAHERALD}.md`.

Sources verified

Verified 2026-05-30: internal doc — no external online sources. Every subcommand, flag, default, and gate-behaviour claim above was derived by running the built rherald binary (`rherald --help`; `rherald changelog-generate|tag-mirror|gate-retest --help`; `rherald version --json`) and reading `commons/branding.go` on 2026-05-30. No flags were invented. Re-verify whenever the rherald Cobra surface changes.